



County Commissioners

Joshua G. Parsons, Chairman
Ray D'Agostino, Vice-Chairman
Craig E. Lehman

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October 4, 2021

Honorable State Representative Seth Grove
Chair, PA House State Government Committee
7 East Wing
PO Box 202196
Harrisburg, PA 17120

Dear Representative Seth Grove and members of the House State Government Committee:

Greetings, my name is Ray D'Agostino, and I am a County Commissioner in Lancaster County. My testimony is in regard to the upcoming Congressional redistricting by the Pennsylvania General Assembly and an imperative request to maintain the entirety of Lancaster County in a single congressional district.

The County of Lancaster, in its entirety, is currently in Pennsylvania's 11th Congressional District and has historically been kept largely or completely within one congressional district. The County is contiguous and consists of compact 984 square-miles with defined boundaries and, according to the 2020 Census, a population of nearly 553,000 people.

The 60 municipalities within Lancaster County share a proud common history and a unique shared bond, which include many distinct characteristics and continuities. Regardless of where you live in the County, whether on a farm, in a suburban or rural township, borough, village or in the City, invariably we think of ourselves as Lancastrians. This is not just a sentiment, it is our sacred past and our hopeful future, as expressed by thousands of County residents and manifestly stated in our recently adopted Comprehensive Plan, Places 2040.

In our Commonwealth, our nation, even worldwide, Lancaster County is known and celebrated as a special place. Whether due our unique and extremely productive farmland, large Plain Sect population, having the oldest inland City in the United States and its Capital for a day, natural beauty of waterways and wooded areas, or world-renowned manufacturing, rooted in ancestral industriousness, Lancaster County is well regarded and thought of as singular entity.

Furthermore, Lancaster County has singular entities that represent and make decisions for the County as opposed to regional ones. For instance, meeting federal guidelines and requirements, Lancaster County has singular Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) to plan and implement transportation projects with federal and state funds. The County also has a singular Workforce Development Board.



From time to time there have been discussions or proposals to split the County of Lancaster into separate congressional districts. To divide Lancaster County into two or more districts would divide us in detrimental ways, dividing our community, diluting our citizens' voice in Congress and create new administrative burdens. Planning and reporting requirements, along with the need to update federal agencies driven by which Congressional district(s) you are located, would hamper our effectiveness. Given these facts, such divisions may well violate fair redistricting principles that focus on keeping communities with defined boundaries, like the County of Lancaster, undivided and contiguous.

Therefore, Lancaster County respectfully requests and urges the General Assembly to maintain the entirety of the County of Lancaster in a single congressional district. To this end, and in a sign of our resolve, the Board of County Commissioners adopted Resolution No. 62 on August 25, 2021 urging this outcome and calling upon all elected officials in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania who represent the people of the County of Lancaster support these goals and to commit to work towards passage of such legislative efforts.

Thank you for your time, consideration and important work on behalf of all Pennsylvanians.

Sincerely,



Ray D'Agostino
County Commissioner

Enclosure: Resolution No. 62 of 2021

RESOLUTION NO. 62 of 2021

IN SUPPORT OF MAINTAINING THE ENTIRETY OF THE COUNTY OF LANCASTER IN A SINGLE CONGRESSIONAL DISTRICT

On motion of Commissioner D'Agostino, seconded by Commissioner Parsons;

WHEREAS, the boundaries of congressional districts in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania are redrawn after every Federal decennial census by legislative action adopted by both chambers of the General Assembly and signed into law by the Governor, and

WHEREAS, the County of Lancaster, in its entirety, is currently in Pennsylvania's 11th Congressional District; and

WHEREAS, the County of Lancaster has historically been kept largely or completely within one Congressional district; and

WHEREAS, the County of Lancaster is a historically contiguous and compact 984 square-mile County with defined boundaries; and

WHEREAS, our community is unique and shares a common history, which includes many distinct characteristics and continuities across the County's 60 municipalities; and

WHEREAS, from time to time there have been discussions or proposals to split the County of Lancaster into separate congressional districts; and

WHEREAS, the splitting of the County of Lancaster into separate congressional districts would divide our community, dilute our citizens' voice in Congress, create administrative problems, and potentially violate fair redistricting principles that focus on keeping communities with defined boundaries, like the County of Lancaster, undivided and contiguous.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the County of Lancaster respectfully requests and urges the General Assembly to maintain the entirety of the County of Lancaster in a single congressional district.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that we call upon all elected officials in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania who represent the people of the County of Lancaster support these goals and to commit to work towards passage of such legislative efforts.

ADOPTED this 25th day of August 2021, by the Board of Commissioners of the County of Lancaster, Pennsylvania in lawful session duly assembled.

ATTEST:



Lawrence M. George
Administrator/Chief Clerk
County of Lancaster, PA



Joshua G. Parsons, Chairman



Ray D'Agostino, Vice Chairman

Craig E. Lehman – Voted No

8/25/21

**Board of Commissioners of
Lancaster County, Pennsylvania**